

Postdoctoral Position in Single-Molecule and Super-Resolution Microscopy Steves Lab, Department of Chemistry, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

The Steves Lab is recruiting a postdoctoral researcher to join our newly established group in the Department of Chemistry at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign. The Steves Lab is part of the highly interdisciplinary microscopy, physical chemistry, and biophysics communities at Illinois, providing opportunities for collaboration across Chemistry and the broader campus.

We develop single-molecule and super-resolution microscopy methods to study the weak, transient interactions that underlie chemistry in complex biological systems. Our work combines instrument and method development with applications to molecular motion and interactions in living cells and model systems. Further information about our research can be found at: <https://msteves.github.io/StevesLab/>

What we offer

- A central role in building a new microscopy-focused research program, including designing and constructing custom instruments and helping establish new experimental capabilities.
- Independent projects at the intersection of physical chemistry, optics, and biophysics, with flexibility to develop your own research directions aligned with the lab's broader research program
- Close, hands-on mentorship and support for your career goals, including grant writing, communication, and mentoring experience

Qualifications

- Ph.D. in chemistry, physics, biophysics, or a related field
- Strong experimental background in fluorescence microscopy, optical spectroscopy/instrumentation, or a closely related area.
- Ability to work independently while contributing actively to a collaborative research environment
- Eager to mentor and work collaboratively with graduate and undergraduate students

Preferred qualifications

Experience in one or more of the following areas:

- Single-molecule fluorescence, super-resolution microscopy, single-particle tracking, or optical instrumentation development
- Live-cell imaging, mammalian cell culture, membrane biophysics, or bioconjugation techniques
- Single-particle spectroscopy, nanomaterials, or DNA nanotechnology
- Quantitative image analysis, optical modeling, or scientific programming (e.g., Python, MATLAB, LabVIEW)

To apply

Send a CV, a brief statement of research experience and interest in the group (~2 pages), and contact information for three references to Megan Steves (msteves@illinois.edu) with the subject line "Steves Lab Microscopy Postdoc – [Last Name]". Applications will be reviewed on a rolling basis until the position is filled.